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Qatar Ministerial Decision No. 9/2026
On the Controls Governing Judicial Procedures by Electronic Means

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The Supreme Judiciary Council,

Pursuant to the perusal of the Civil and Commercial Procedures Law issued by Qatar Law No. 13/1990 and its amendments;

The Criminal Procedure Law promulgated by Qatar Law No. 23/2004, and its amending laws;

The Electronic Commerce and Transactions Law promulgated by Qatar Decree-Law No. 16/2010;

Qatar Law No. 24/2017 on the national address; and

The Judicial Authority Law promulgated by Qatar Law No. 8/2023,

Hereby decides as follows:

Article 1

In application of the provisions of this Decision, the following terms and expressions shall have the meanings assigned thereto, unless the context requires otherwise:

Council: The Supreme Judiciary Council.

Court: The court that originally has the jurisdiction to hear the case.

Video Hearing: A hearing during which the litigation proceedings are conducted through audio-visual remote communication technology.

Virtual Hearing: A court hearing in which the litigation procedures are conducted electronically through the submission and exchange of memoranda and the filing of requests electronically.

Ordinary Hearing: A court hearing that is held inside the courtroom in the presence of the parties, in accordance with the ordinary procedures prescribed by law.

Article 2

A Video Hearing or Virtual Hearing shall be conducted at the Circuits determined by a decision of the Chairman of the Council.

Article 3

The Video or Virtual Hearing shall be conducted through the National Authentication System or the electronic systems of the Council, as the case may be, and attendance is allowed for the parties of a lawsuit and their lawyers. Any witness, expert, interpreter, or other concerned person shall be permitted to attend the hearings.

Article 4

The court shall take into consideration the trial guarantees prescribed by law when the proceedings are conducted electronically, particularly the following:

1. Ensuring the attendance of the parties or verifying that they have been duly and legally notified.
2. Enabling the parties to submit applications, review all memoranda and documents submitted during the hearing, and respond thereto.
3. Documenting and maintaining the electronic procedures while ensuring their confidentiality
4. Providing technical assistance to the parties to enable them to access the electronic system.

Article 5

Access to the Virtual or Video Hearing shall be through the National Authentication System or the Council’s electronic systems, or via the notification link to the national address, as the case may be.

Article 6

The electronic system shows the number of persons attending the hearing and their capacities.

Article 7

The sessions shall be held during official working hours. The Court may hold the sessions at any other time deemed adequate if this is required.

Article 8

The court may order personal attendance if it is not possible to hold a Video or Virtual Hearing, or if the interests so require at any stage of litigation. The parties may also request that an Ordinary Hearing be held if there are serious reasons accepted by the court, and the parties shall be notified of its date.

Article 9

The Video Hearing shall be public, unless if the court decides sua sponte or at the request of one of the litigants that they be secret, in maintenance of the public order or in consideration of the morals or the sanctity of the family life.

Article 10

The Virtual Hearing shall be held without the presence of the parties, through the filing and exchange of memoranda between them and the submission of requests within the legal deadlines.

The Court may hold an Ordinary Hearing if this is deemed adequate.

Article 11

The Court Registry shall prepare the electronic system and activate the links sufficiently before the commencement of the hearing with sufficient time.

Article 12

Maintaining order and managing the Video Hearing shall be the responsibility of the presiding judge who shall have the right to grant or restrict the speaking and listening functions on the electronic system.

Article 13

Taking into consideration the approved information security policy in the State, it is prohibited to commit any act that may obstruct the course of judicial proceedings or breach the privacy of the parties, including recording or filming Virtual or Video Hearings, except with the written permission of the Chief Judge.

Article 14

The deliberation shall be confidential and conducted electronically among the judges who heard the pleading, sitting together, via the electronic system, and no person other than them shall be allowed to attend the deliberation.

Article 15

Judgements shall be issued electronically, and the publication of the judgement on the Council’s electronic system shall be deemed equivalent to pronouncing the judgement in a public hearing.

The parties shall have the right to challenge the judgement through the electronic system, within the time-limits prescribed by law for filing challenges.

Article 16

The rules set out in this Decision shall apply to Video or Virtual Hearings in criminal proceedings, insofar as they do not conflict with the guarantees stipulated in the Criminal Procedures Law referred to herein.

Article 17

In case the law requires a signature on a document or stipulates that legal effects result from the absence of the signature, an electronic signature that meets the prescribed requirements shall be deemed as evidence in attributing the document to its issuer, including witnesses, experts, and others.

Article 18

All competent authorities, each within its scope of competence, shall implement this Decision, which shall enter into force from the day following the date of its publication in the Official Gazette.

Issued on: 21/10/1447 H.

Corresponding to: 09/04/2026

Dr. Hassan bin Lahdan Alhassan Almohanadi,

Chairman of the Supreme Judicial Council

President of the Court of Cassation

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